Arsalan Awan

Technical Game Designer | Level Design | Mobile Puzzle | Unity / C# | Procedural Generation
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SUMMARY

Technical game designer with 3+ years in mobile game development and 7 shipped F2P puzzle titles as primary designer. I own core loops, mechanics, FTUE, progression and difficulty curves, then build the tools that prove them: procedural level generators, solvers, playtesting bots and KPI dashboards, and make data-driven design decisions from player telemetry (fail rate, churn, retention, funnels).

WORK EXPERIENCE

Mindstorm Studios – *Game Designer* ***Jun 2024 – Present***

- Primary game designer on 7 shipped Google Play titles: Hex Up! (Lion Studios), PuzzlePic, Sand Flow, Yarn Collect, KittyDoku, CarDoku, Mice Flow; owned core loop, mechanics, art direction, **FTUE** and **progression**, and shipped **1,300+ levels** (PuzzlePic 500, Sand Flow 500, Yarn Collect 150, KittyDoku/CarDoku/Mice Flow 50 each).
- Built Mice Flow end-to-end as a solo developer, from design and code to 3D art, using **AI-assisted workflows** (Meshy, Claude, Codex).
- Built an **AI-assisted procedural level generation** pipeline (Python, FastAPI, React, Docker) for Sand Flow, turning pixel art into playable Unity levels with mechanic budgets, synergy rules and difficulty scoring.
- Calibrated the **difficulty curve** against bot fail rates across 164 levels into normal/hard/super-hard bands; showed on 105 live levels that fail rate predicts **churn** ($\rho = 0.89$) while level position does not.
- Wrote a **C# autoplay solver** (BFS pathing + belt simulation) covering all 8 Sand Flow mechanics, plus headless simulation and replay tools for **automated level validation**.
- Built a **funnel analysis** tool over BI data with confidence intervals and difficulty-spike detection; analysed 161 levels from a live iOS UA campaign; ran **A/B tests** on level ordering against churn and **monetization** KPIs.
- **Rapid prototyping:** took hybrid-casual concepts from **competitor analysis** of 4,000+ levels to rule specs, level editors, solver-verified levels and greedy/random **playtesting bots** in under two weeks each.

SmallCity Studios – *Co-Founder, Head of Development & Marketing* ***Oct 2023 – Mar 2024***

- Raised **PKR 1M** in investment; developed and published Rope Swing and Car Garage Racing 3D on Google Play (3,000+ downloads).
- Ran a Meta campaign with Homa Games for the US market: **25% D1 retention** at **$1.27 CPI**; optimized Google Ads to a PKR 10.44 CPI at 7.64% conversion.
- Architected projects with Command/Factory patterns and **ScriptableObjects**; built a multiplayer prototype with Netcode for GameObjects and Unity Relay.

Ajax Studios – *Game Developer & Level Designer* ***May 2023 – Sep 2023***

- Designed level concepts and built decoupled systems (Event Bus pattern), a reusable script library and optimizations (object pooling, mesh combining) with the art team.

PROJECTS

Link Sort FTUE Review – independent study for a mobile studio (2026) – drive.google.com/file/d/1_1TzYHRQWPR6QpBPdaCUb4UfTJjZ8NAS

- Diagnosed early-level churn with a solver and frame-by-frame competitor benchmarks: the game's move rule tripled legal opening moves (30.5 vs 10.4) on near-identical boards; colour fragmentation explained ~50% of fail variance.
- Showed new colours double churn (15.0% vs 7.5%); proved levels 1–4 unlosable, exposing misreported fail rates.

Kites in a Storm – narrative time-loop game, Unity 6 (in development): wrote the story bible and cause-and-effect systems map; simulated 150 players per behaviour type to tune pacing (71% completion, 89-min median).

EDUCATION

Lahore University of Management Sciences – *BSc Management Sciences, Computer Science Minor* ***2019 – 2023***
Key Courses: Artificial Intelligence, Optimization Methods, Decision Analysis, Probability & Statistics.

SKILLS

Design: Level Design, Core Loop & Mechanics, Difficulty Curves & Balancing, Progression, FTUE, Procedural Content Generation, Playtesting, A/B Testing, KPIs (Retention, Churn, Fail Rate, CPI), Competitor Analysis, GDD & Spec Writing.
Technical: Unity (C#, URP, Editor Tools, ScriptableObjects, Test Framework), Python, JavaScript/TypeScript, React, FastAPI, Docker, Git, GitHub Actions, Figma, AI Tools (Claude, Codex, Meshy, OpenAI/Anthropic APIs).
Interests: Writing stories & poetry, guitar, video games and board games.